
DERMABAY: THE PROOF GAP

When “science-backed” stops being a differentiator.

An independent strategic growth investigation.

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2026 PUBLIC-DATA RESEARCH PROJECT. NOT COMMISSIONED CLIENT WORK.

01 — THE QUESTION

Making Existing Credibility Harder to Ignore

Dermabay already possesses what many skincare brands spend years trying to build: scientific expertise, R&D credibility, effective products, customer proof, and founder authority.

The strategic question is not how Dermabay can simply do more marketing. Instead, the focus is on how the brand can make its existing advantages harder to ignore.

The core hypothesis is that the current problem is not a lack of marketing assets, but rather how those scientific assets are translated into meaningful consumer differentiation.

01 — SCIENCE + R&D

Scientific expertise and formulation credibility.

02 — PRODUCT + CUSTOMER

Effective products and customer proof.

03 — FOUNDER AUTHORITY

Technical expertise and existing authority.

DESTINATION

THE STRATEGIC GAP

How existing scientific and credibility assets become meaningful consumer differentiation.

Six-Angle Strategic Brand Investigation

This independent research approach investigated the brand across six distinct angles to find the gap between what Dermabay has, what customers value, and what the category already owns:

01 — BRAND

What does Dermabay say it stands for?

02 — PRODUCT

Where does visible customer traction appear?

03 — CUSTOMER

What language do customers actually use?

04 — CATEGORY

What are competitors already claiming?

05 — MARKETING

How are education, products, and authority connected?

06 — JOURNEY

What happens from discovery to purchase to repeat?

EVIDENCE SYNTHESIS

WHAT DERMABAY HAS

Scientific expertise + products + authority

WHAT CUSTOMERS VALUE

Practical benefits + experience + results

WHAT THE CATEGORY OWNS

Science + ingredients + testing + expertise

THE STRATEGIC GAP

"Science is not differentiated simply by being science-backed. The opportunity is to make Dermabay's proof specific, visible, and connected to consumer choice."

RESEARCH BASIS: Public official channels, product pages, customer reviews, marketplace evidence, and competitor research.

BRAND POSITIONING

Science-Backed vs. Distinctive Choice

01 — CURRENT POSITIONING

Dermabay positions itself heavily around science, formulation, Indian skin, pharmaceutical expertise, transparency, and results. Company communication emphasizes active molecules and products designed for the Indian climate.

02 — THE STRATEGIC DISTINCTION

A brand can have scientific credibility without that credibility becoming a **distinctive consumer reason to choose it**.

"Currently, these credentials exist as isolated claims rather than active conversion assets that drive the consumer's purchasing decision."

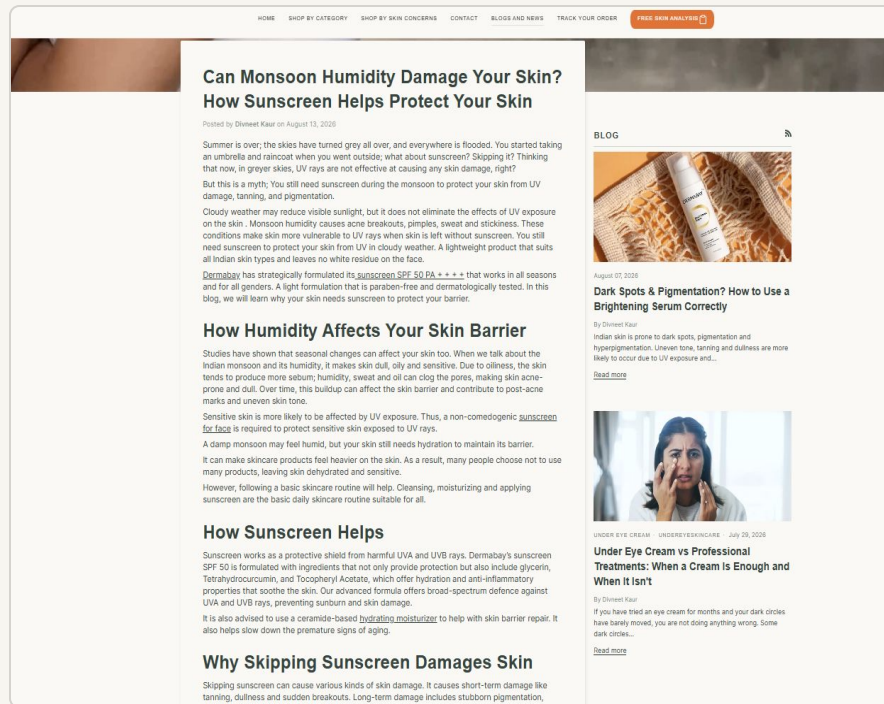


FIG. 01 — CURRENT EDUCATION POSITIONING

Research-Driven vs. Benefit-Driven

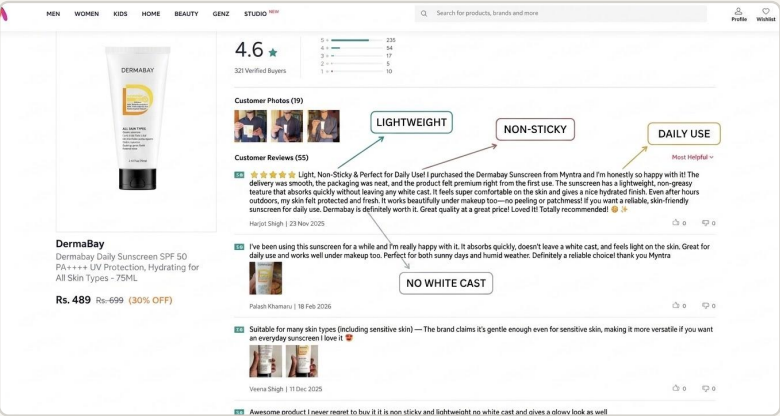
Customers may be research-driven during discovery, but they are benefit-driven at purchase.

While Dermabay describes its audience as highly informed, customer reviews reveal a different priority at purchase: immediate everyday benefits.

LIGHTWEIGHT	RESULTS
NON-STICKY	DAILY USE
NO WHITE CAST	COMFORT
HYDRATION	VALUE

Scientific information must become a practical reason the customer can understand and act on.

CUSTOMER EVIDENCE



CUSTOMER LANGUAGE

Everyday reviews & highlighted tags

Lightweight · Non-sticky · No white cast · Hydration ·
Daily use · Comfort · Results · Value

03 — THE CATEGORY: Competitive Analysis

Dermabay is competing in an over-saturated category where "science-backed" is no longer rare. Competitors have already translated science into distinct territories:

Minimalist — Science translated into ingredient specificity

Deconstruct — Science translated into testing and proof

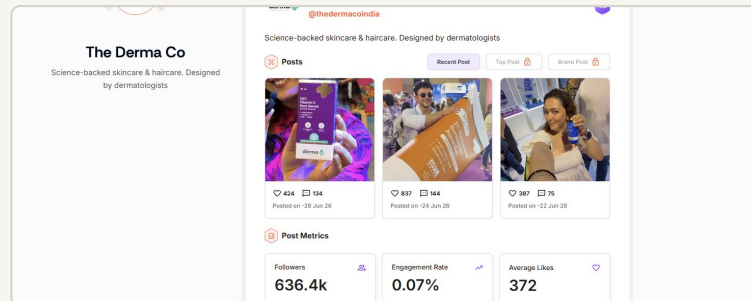
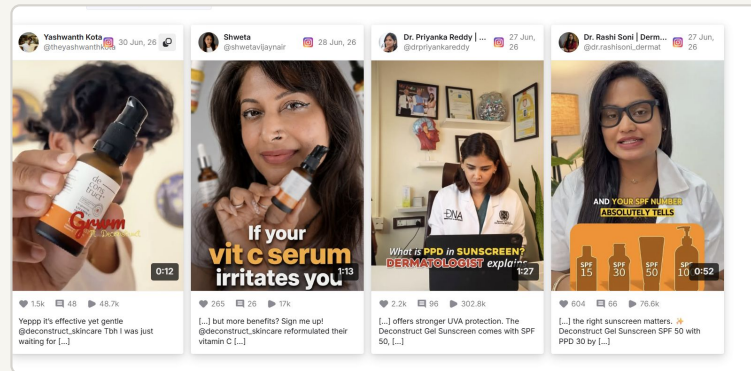
The Derma Co — Science translated into clinical authority and scale

Foxtale — Science translated into consumer experience

STRATEGIC REQUIREMENT

"The strategic requirement is not to talk more about science, but to make Dermabay's science more believable, specific, and difficult to substitute."

CATEGORY EVIDENCE



[THE CONTRADICTION]



THE BRAND

Focuses heavily on "Science, formulation, and active molecules."

THE CATEGORY

Claims parity: "We also possess clinical science and ingredients."

THE CUSTOMER

Asks practical questions: "Is it lightweight? Is it comfortable?"

THE STRATEGIC REALISATION

The true value is not the science itself,
but what Dermabay can actively prove with it
to resolve real-world user friction.

Feature-Led Claims vs. Proof-Backed Choice

MODEL A: FEATURE-LED

- 01. Science
- 02. Claim
- 03. Product
- 04. Purchase

MODEL B: PROOF-BACKED

- 01. Science
- 02. Real Problem
- 03. Formulation
- 04. Proof
- 05. Product
- 06. Experience
- 07. Customer Proof

SHIFT
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The traditional paradigm pushes laboratory science directly to transactional claims without context.

The strategic opportunity shifts to Proof-Backed Choice.

By embedding evidence, formulation intent, and consumer experiences directly into the brand architecture, we move beyond basic feature claims.

"Here is what we formulated differently, here is why, and here is the evidence."

CASE STUDY SUBJECT: SPF 50

The Proof Lab SPF 50 Experiment

The Creative Tension: Protection vs. Experience

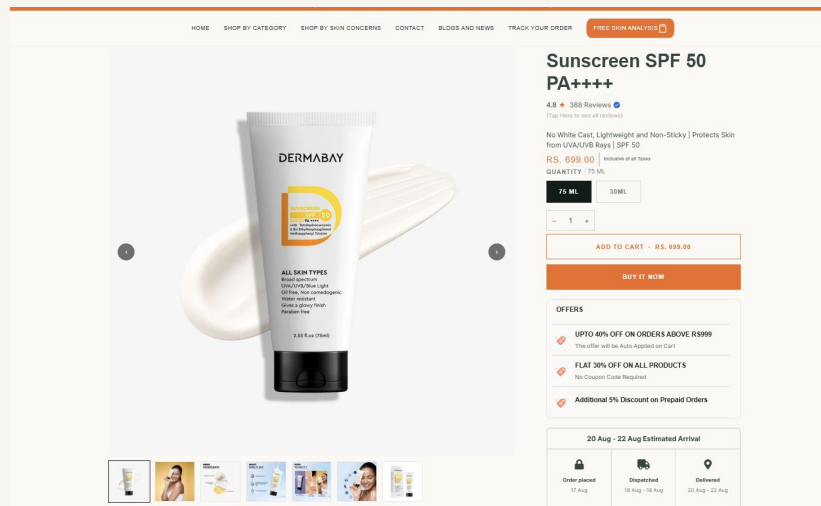
01 — THE TENSION

Everyday sensory barriers, such as heavy feel and visible white cast, can create friction around consistent daily sunscreen use.

02 — THE STRATEGIC RESPONSE

The experiment leverages sensory barriers as the discovery entry point, then uses clinical science to justify the formulation choice.

PROTECTION ↔ EXPERIENCE



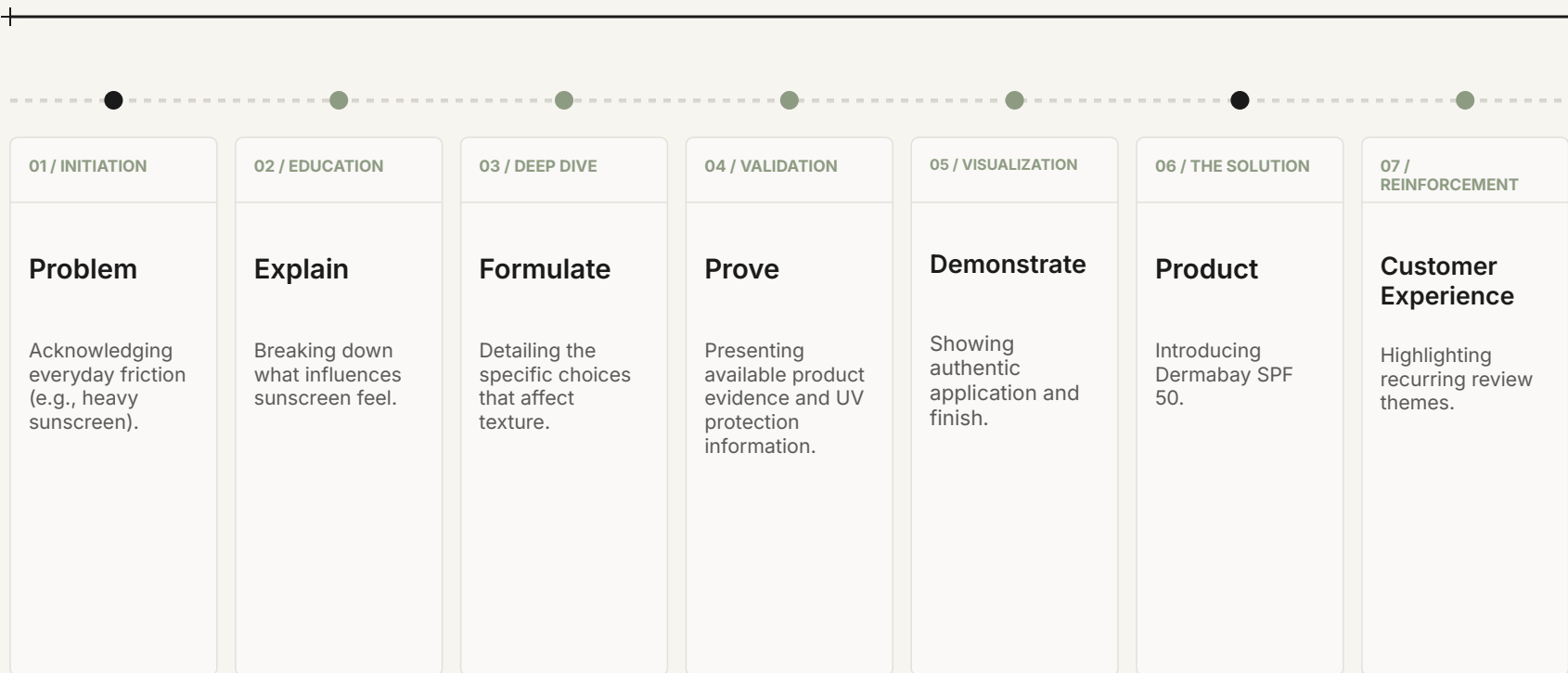
EVIDENCE — PRODUCT EXPERIENCE: DERMABAY SCREENSHOT

03 — THE EXPERIENCE / EVIDENCE

The product experience maps physical characteristics such as texture and wearability alongside formulation information, making the proof easier to connect to the everyday use case.

"Here is what we formulated differently, here is why, and here is the evidence."

06 — CONTENT SYSTEM *Problem-to-Proof Architecture*

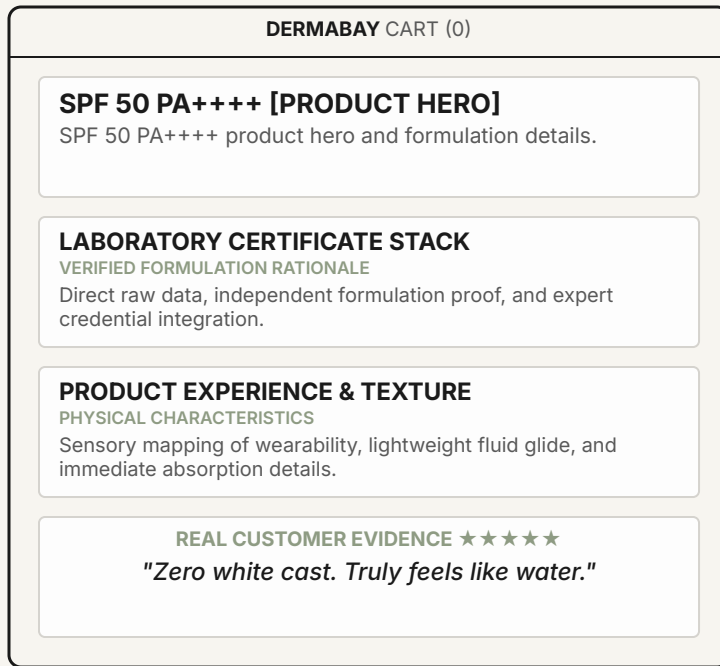


Conversion-Oriented Product Page Experiment

The campaign directs traffic to a redesigned, proof-led product page structured to solve trust friction.

- 01 — The Problem** — Why daily sunscreen is difficult to use.
- 02 — The Formulation** — What Dermabay chose and why.
- 03 — The Proof Stack** — Specifications, rationale, expert proof, and testing.
- 04 — The Experience** — What the product feels and looks like.
- 05 — The Customer** — Recurring review themes like "no white cast".
- 06 — The Product** — SPF 50 PA++++ formulation details.

Wireframe Blueprint: Proof-Led Product Page



The Project: Control vs. Variant Test Design

A proposed A/B test designed to measure the impact of proof-led communication on product intent.

CONTROL — GENERIC CAMPAIGN

"Dermabay SPF 50 PA++++ — lightweight, non-sticky sunscreen for daily protection."

Standard claim-based copy focused entirely on product attributes without establishing preceding user pain points.

VARIANT — PROBLEM + PROOF SYSTEM

"Why does sunscreen feel heavy? Here's what Dermabay changed in the formula for everyday wear."

Problem-led copy addressing a common friction point, followed immediately by formula changes as strategic proof.

PROPOSED MEASUREMENT: PRIMARY BEHAVIOR

Product-Page Progression

Tracing user progression across critical touchpoints:
Content → Product Page → Add-to-Cart.

PROPOSED MEASUREMENT: SECONDARY SIGNALS

Proof Engagement Auditing

Proposed auditing of active micro-interactions with formulation, scientific evidence, credentials, and customer-proof sections.

The 90-Day Build: Strategic Roadmap

01

DAYS 0-30

Build the Proof Library

- Select high-value consumer problems
- Map formulation evidence
- Organize available testing

Strategic Purpose: To establish the evidence base before scaling communication.

02

DAYS 31-60

Put Proof into the Market

- Launch Proof Lab content
- Test problem-led messaging
- Connect content directly to product pages

Strategic Purpose: Translate the evidence into market-facing communication and test which problem/proof narratives create stronger product intent.

03

DAYS 61-90

Compound the Winners

- Identify the strongest problem/product combinations
- Build post-purchase education
- Scale validated formats

Strategic Purpose: Build on the strongest validated problem/proof combinations rather than simply producing more content.

Funnel Measurement Framework

Success is not measured by follower counts or impressions alone. The strategy is evaluated across the full growth funnel:

01

ATTENTION

Qualified reach and branded search.



02

CONSIDERATION

Product-page visits, content-to-product clicks, and Add-to-cart rates.



03

CONVERSION

Purchase conversion, Average Order Value (AOV), and new-customer conversion.



04

RETENTION

Repeat purchases, cross-selling, and routine adoption.



05

ADVOCACY

Authentic reviews, user-generated content, and referrals.

The Final Thesis: Proof-Led Growth

"Dermabay does not have a simple marketing problem; it already possesses science, R&D, and customer proof. The strategic opportunity is to connect these assets differently."

01 — SCIENCE & R&D

Existing scientific credibility and formulation knowledge.



02 — FORMULATION + PRODUCT EXPERIENCE

Make formulation choices and everyday product experience visible and understandable.



03 — CUSTOMER PROOF

Use recurring customer evidence and real-world experience as proof.



PROOF-LED CHOICE

"Here is what we formulated differently, here is why, and here is the evidence."

Strategic Implication: Build a premium, competitive distinctiveness by making science specific, visible, and believable.

09 — STRATEGIC CHOICE MATRIX

STRATEGIC ROUTE	DISTINCTIVENESS	RELEVANCE	DEFENSIBILITY	ROLE
OPTION A Proof-Led Differentiation Turns R&D credibility into a visible proof system that creates differentiated strategic territory.	HIGH	HIGH	HIGH	PRIMARY STRATEGY Immediate strategic focus.
OPTION B Hero Product » Routine Engine Uses a high-relevance sunscreen/product entry point to build trust and pull customers into broader routines.	MEDIUM	HIGH	MEDIUM	SUPPORTING PLAY Use as an organic growth mechanism.
OPTION C Founder / R&D Authority Engine Turns technical founder expertise and laboratory rigor into a secondary consumer education and authority layer.	HIGH	MEDIUM	HIGH	SUPPORTING LAYER Integrate as a secondary narrative layer.
Proof-Led Differentiation becomes the strategic core; product and founder authority operate as supporting growth layers.				